insurance industry to work together and suggest solutions on various relevant issues in the sector. The IRDA is also co-ordinating with and supporting insurance industry initiatives in standardizing certain key terminology used in health insurance documents, for better comprehension and in the interest of policyholders. The ***General Insurance Council,*** comprising all non-life insurers, evolved a consensus on a uniform definition of 'preexisting diseases' and its exclusion wording, which has earlier been an expression with many definitions, still more interpretations, and certainly a whole lot of grievances. Such standardization, effective 1 June 2008 will help the insured by minimizing ambiguity and also by better comparability of health insurance products. Also, with effect from 1 October 2011, portability in health insurance has been started in which an insured, if not happy with services or the product of the existing insurer, can change to another insurer whilst enjoying the benefits (especially that of pre-existing diseases) of her/his existing policy.

2. **Micro Insurance:** Micro insurance regulations issued by the IRDA have provided a fillip to propagating micro insurance as a conceptual issue. With the positive and facilitative approach adopted under the micro insurance regulations, it is expected that all insurance companies would come out with a progressive business approach and carry forward the spirit of regulations thereby extending insurance penetration to all segments of society. Presently, there are 10,482 micro insurance agents operating in the micro insurance sector.
3. **Insurance Laws (Amendment) Bill 2008:** The Bill aimed to amend the Insurance Act 1938, the General Insurance Business (Nationalisation) Act 1972, and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority Act 1999. The Standing Committee on Finance has submitted its report to the Parliament on 13 December 2011. The report of the Committee is under examination by the government. Amendments to the LIC Act 1956: The LIC (Amendment) Bill, 2011 was passed by Parliament on 12 December 2011. The amendments will enable the LIC to raise its equity capital from Rs. 5 crore to Rs. 100 crore and create a *reserve fund* to be